

Can someone explain the correlation between AI and water usage/ killing trees?

Posted by u/LimitedNicotine • • 0 points • 1 comments

I see data, articles etc. Explaining one chatGPT prompt = 40 drops of water or X number of trees are killed, but I don't understand the correlation. I'm not a proponent of AI, just want to get a better understanding of the consequences.

Comments

u/archpaw • 1 points • 2026-03-08 23:44 UTC

[The effects of chatbots are massively overblown.](<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/a-cheat-sheet-for-conversations-about>)

Here's the section on [water usage](<https://andymasley.substack.com/p/a-cheat-sheet-for-conversations-about?open=false#%C2%A7water>). An average person uses about 1600 liters of water a day (mostly from water used to grow the food you eat). A chatbot uses about 2 mL per prompt. So if you did 500 prompts per day for 1600 days, that would be as bad as the amount of water you use in a single day. Granted, going without food would kill you, but the amount of water used varies wildly. Just eat something that uses less water once a year and you'll make up for using chatbots all you want.